

Table 1: Summary Statistics

Variable	Unit	N	Mean	SD	Min	P25	Median	P75	Max
<i>A. Independent Variables</i>									
ClarityCEO	C	61,626	0.2143	0.2129	-0.7717	0.0952	0.2365	0.3629	0.8614
ClarityCEO_QtrExp	C	25,520	0.2011	0.2281	-1.0232	0.0713	0.2256	0.3589	0.8694
GEPU_log	C	88,205	4.6872	0.3672	3.8626	4.3797	4.7238	4.9666	5.5106
PRisk	C	85,995	99.6187	146.5189	0.0000	17.0778	53.3729	120.1973	1192.4308
PRisk_lag2	C	80,627	99.9614	147.2392	0.0000	17.1702	53.4446	120.2666	1192.4308
TotalSimilarity	F	22,403	3.4277	5.6522	1.0000	1.1246	1.5865	3.0903	80.1876
US_EPU_log	C	88,205	4.7123	0.3661	3.8018	4.4805	4.6891	4.9625	5.6478
UncPreCEO	C	71,727	0.6602	0.3917	0.0000	0.3810	0.6001	0.8723	2.2432
UncResCEO	C	44,900	-0.0000	0.3010	-1.5108	-0.1846	-0.0180	0.1650	1.7794
UncResCEO_QtrExp	C	25,520	-0.0057	0.3208	-1.6084	-0.2028	-0.0210	0.1707	1.7402
Unrated	C	79,487	0.5159	0.4997	0.0000	0.0000	1.0000	1.0000	1.0000
<i>B. Dependent Variables</i>									
BGTLevel_Spread	C	87,018	0.0017	0.0026	0.0001	0.0004	0.0009	0.0017	0.0164
BGTLevel_Spread_lead1	C	82,843	0.0016	0.0024	0.0001	0.0004	0.0009	0.0016	0.0164
CCCL	C	88,205	0.0032	0.0563	0.0000	0.0000	0.0000	0.0000	1.0000
CashRatio	C	87,990	0.1708	0.1806	0.0000	0.0368	0.1047	0.2435	0.9938
CashRatio_lead	C	82,236	0.1715	0.1748	0.0000	0.0407	0.1112	0.2447	0.9938
<i>C. Firm Controls</i>									
AbsSurpDec	C	61,544	2.9300	1.4255	0.0000	2.0000	3.0000	4.0000	5.0000
Capex	C	87,627	0.0487	0.0536	0.0000	0.0176	0.0324	0.0592	0.5203
CashFlowAt	C	87,670	0.1019	0.1147	-3.0324	0.0608	0.1032	0.1526	0.4874
DailyVola	C	82,599	36.7556	21.2437	9.4388	22.9709	31.2762	43.8148	211.9160
DivDummy	C	88,134	0.4755	0.4994	0.0000	0.0000	0.0000	1.0000	1.0000
EarnVol	C	87,440	0.0701	0.1907	0.0006	0.0163	0.0315	0.0695	19.5101
FirmMat	C	87,571	-0.0432	2.1826	-317.5714	-0.0078	0.2191	0.4195	0.9252
Leverage	C	87,994	0.2330	0.2240	0.0000	0.0470	0.2065	0.3455	3.9453
NegCall	C	86,858	0.9210	0.3024	0.0000	0.7038	0.8798	1.0943	2.3901
RDSales	C	87,647	0.1047	0.9342	0.0000	0.0000	0.0048	0.0636	39.7688
ROA	C	87,552	0.0386	0.1330	-3.9826	0.0146	0.0525	0.0925	0.5490
SalesGrowth	C	87,506	0.1173	0.3849	-1.0000	-0.0043	0.0745	0.1762	10.3051
StockPrice	C	87,188	36.8864	32.8119	1.6100	14.8975	28.2400	48.1700	192.0384
TobinsQ	C	87,363	2.1363	1.5197	0.3847	1.2681	1.6791	2.4362	35.6144
Turnover	C	87,188	0.0260	0.0299	0.0007	0.0083	0.0160	0.0310	0.1697
UncQue	C	81,031	1.4398	0.4831	0.0000	1.1216	1.4108	1.7268	3.5945
lnAssets	C	87,994	7.4710	1.6607	-0.5692	6.3008	7.3763	8.5436	12.4592
sCFO	C	83,662	0.0619	0.2233	0.0014	0.0236	0.0395	0.0664	32.4035

Notes: Summary statistics for variables used in the hypothesis tests. Sample period: 2002–2018. Anchor sample (H1, Main): 88,205 earnings-call observations across 1,884 firms. Unit column: C = call-level, F = firm-year. N varies by row because each variable is summarized on its anchor panel's Main sample (complete cases per variable); per-suite samples differ due to lags, control availability, and merges.